

AUDITION CHECKLIST

Six Characters in Search of an Author

Sei personaggi in cerca d'autore

Luigi Pirandello · trans. Edward Storer (1922)

Village Players · Lausanne

Director: Kiarash Jamshidi

DIRECTOR'S WORKING PAGES

HOW TO USE THESE PAGES

One page per role, plus an auditioner-info form at the front and a general assessment page at the back. Tick the boxes during the audition. Write the auditioner's name and date at the top of each role page so the pages don't get mixed up across the morning.

Each role page assesses an actor's **capacity** for the role across four standard categories: **Voice & breath**, **Character & text**, **Body & presence**, and **Direction-taking & range**. The items are role-specific (the Father has long philosophical speeches; the Mother holds long silences; the Step-Daughter needs to be sharp without being shrill) but the categories are the same throughout. They are the questions any audition is trying to answer.

The general assessment page at the back covers the fundamentals across all roles — voice & speech, body & presence, text work, acting fundamentals, direction-taking, ensemble & practical, and the bigger questions for this production specifically.

The final box on each page — *Yes / Maybe / No* — is your snap impression. Use the lined notes area for anything more specific.

Auditioner

IDENTITY

Full name _____

Date of audition _____

Phone _____ Email _____

LANGUAGES

English _____ French _____

Other _____ Native _____

ROLES AUDITIONING FOR

Primary _____

Open to _____

AVAILABILITY

Audition: Tue 2 / Fri 5 / Wed 10 June 2026, 18:00 – 21:00, SSA Lausanne _____

Table-work: Thursdays 18 June – 30 July 2026, 18:00 – 21:00, SSA Lausanne _____

Staging: 20 August – 1 November 2026 (5 & 13 Aug summer break; weekly Thursdays + some weekends) _____

Late autumn 2026 (performance run) _____

Known conflicts (specific dates) _____

PRACTICAL

Headshot/résumé received _____ Available for callbacks _____

Auditioner _____

Date _____

The Father

the brain of the family

A well-educated middle-class man whose intellectual elegance is his shield against shame. The philosophy is autobiographical, disguised as metaphysics. The role lives or dies on the actor's ability to fight for his own existence in real time.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Vocal range and stamina to carry the long Act One and Act Three speeches without strain
- ☐ Breath control under intellectual pressure — does not run out at the end of a clause
- ☐ Can move from mellifluous to violent without losing register
- ☐ Voice breaks honestly at the right moments (does not pre-load the break)
- ☐ Earned pauses, not filler
- ☐ Specificity of word choice — discovers each key word as he says it

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Plays the speeches as defence and survival, not as lecture
- ☐ Believes every paradox he speaks, in real time
- ☐ Holds the contradiction between his elegance and his shame
- ☐ Audience can hear the philosophy as autobiographical
- ☐ Available for a four-stage arc: composure → injury → attack → exposure
- ☐ Listens to the Step-Daughter as she cuts him; does not anticipate her
- ☐ Holds the silence after each of her cuts — does not rescue himself too fast

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Comfortable with shame as a visible physiological event
- ☐ Holds stillness when he is losing the argument
- ☐ Movement is specific, not generalised
- ☐ Available for the Step-Daughter's close-proximity blocking on stage

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Takes an adjustment between takes and holds it
- ☐ Available for the line read in three different registers (light, urgent, broken)
- ☐ Asks specific questions about the text rather than general questions about the play

NOTES

VERDICT

☐

Yes

☐

Maybe

☐

No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

The Mother

silence that finally screams

Silence is her language. The body does her acting. Most of the part is not text. The role needs an actor who is alive when she is not speaking, and who can deliver the keystone line without performing it.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Voice carries the cry at Madame Pace and at the fountain without being pushed
- ☐ Keystone line — *It's taking place now. It happens all the time* — lands without ornament
- ☐ Speech is humble, peasant-class register; uncomplicated rhythm
- ☐ Available for long stretches of silence without filling them with sound

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Does not perform sympathy or grief; plays the suffering itself
- ☐ Three different silences distinguishable (Act 1 — does not yet believe she will be heard / Act 2 — being made to watch / Act 3 — holding both children at once)
- ☐ Available to be looked at without flinching
- ☐ Listens to everyone on stage — including those she is not facing

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Stillness reads as presence, not passivity
- ☐ Body is specific — the actor has decided what the Mother's hands are doing at every moment
- ☐ Comfortable holding the bundle for long stretches
- ☐ Comfortable with the chair-and-coat as the second child
- ☐ Available for the staged moment where the Father raises her veil
- ☐ Eyes can stay on the floor for extended periods without dropping focus

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Available for delicate adjustment without breaking the stillness
- ☐ Resists the temptation to make the role bigger
- ☐ Trusts the script to do the work

NOTES

VERDICT

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

The Step-Daughter

the one who refuses to let it be made beautiful

The moral centre of the play. The role lives or dies on whether the actor can be sharp without being shrill, funny because furious, and direct without ornament. Refuses to be made delicate.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Voice level and unforced in the surgical cuts against the Father
- ☐ Can land a long speech (the Madame Pace recall, the bundle monologue) without becoming theatrical
- ☐ Has range from cold flat delivery to the bundle-tenderness in the same scene
- ☐ Earned pauses; does not pad the lines

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Sharp without being shrill
- ☐ Comedy and pain in the same beat — the wit is real, the wit is rage
- ☐ Refuses to be played as delicate or victimised
- ☐ Refuses to soften her own line
- ☐ Tenderness for the bundle is unbearably real, not sentimental
- ☐ Holds the cuts against the Father as moral intervention, not as taunt

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Reads young — the audience must see the age difference with the Father
- ☐ Knows how to use a room without flirting
- ☐ Comfortable with the bundle as her sister
- ☐ Available for the staged close-proximity work with the Father actor

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Available for the line read in two registers (open, attacking)
- ☐ Takes a note about coldness specifically — can dial intensity down without losing the line
- ☐ Trusts the audience to read her without help

NOTES

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☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

The Son

the one who will not act

The production's most modern figure. The adult child who refuses to participate in a parent's narrative. The role lives or dies on the actor's ability to hold stillness as presence and to let two moments — the mirror speech, the fountain narration — break out of him.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Quiet voice that carries
- ☐ Mirror speech earns its own cry mid-sentence (does not pre-load)
- ☐ Fountain narration available in broken beats, not flowing prose
- ☐ Comfortable with monosyllables

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Refusal is an aesthetic and ethical position — not stubbornness or sulk
- ☐ Cold without disengagement; cares without showing it
- ☐ Reads ~22 (or convincingly so) — modern, recognisable
- ☐ Available for stretches of stage time without speaking
- ☐ Two moments where the wound breaks out (the mirror speech, the fountain narration) — earns both

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Stillness reads as presence, not blankness
- ☐ Has chosen what the body is doing during long silences and committed to it
- ☐ Comfortable being held by the shoulders by the Father in the Act Three confrontation
- ☐ Available to be looked at by other characters without performing a reaction

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Available to dial up and down — refusal can be quieter or louder without losing meaning
- ☐ Takes adjustment without becoming defensive about the character's coldness
- ☐ Trusts that not doing is doing

NOTES

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☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

The Manager

a tired director — and, without trying, the audience's stand-in

A tired director, trying all day to solve a rehearsal problem. The audience recognise themselves in him because of how he reacts — practically, selfishly, curiously, too late — not because he plays it. The role lives or dies on the actor's ability to be practical, warm, and recognisable — not theatrical, not directorial in cliché.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Working-director voice — practical, not declamatory
- ☐ Carries the rhythm of a real rehearsal room
- ☐ Comic timing without commenting on the joke
- ☐ Closing line played straight, with no irony — the most demanding single line in the part

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Plays him as the audience proxy throughout
- ☐ Cynicism is technique; compassion is real — both visible in the same scene
- ☐ Almost understands what he is watching; never quite admits it
- ☐ Curiosity wins out over the schedule by Act Two
- ☐ Almost names Pirandello in Act Three Part Two and stops himself
- ☐ Pivot moment (setting the chair-and-coat behind the fountain) carries the weight of accessory, not just stage business

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Sits the way the audience sits — forward, half-engaged
- ☐ Comfortable being looked at across long Act 3 stretches
- ☐ Movement is functional, not theatrical
- ☐ Available for long Act 3 stretches without losing energy or focus

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Takes adjustment on temperature (warmer / cooler) without losing the role
- ☐ Available for the line read with three different relationships to the audience
- ☐ Generous with scene partners — does not pull focus when the Father or Step-Daughter are speaking

NOTES

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☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

Player 1

one character in five hats — the Leading Man underneath (forties)

In his forties — the eldest of the Players, and the vain faded Anglo Leading Man. The role asks an actor to play five different functions (Leading Man, L'Ingénue, Door-keeper, Machinist, Third Actor) as the same man underneath, without losing the spine. Vanity as defence, with affection beneath it. He performs seniority; Player 2, younger, actually has the standing. He does not know he is funny.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Anglo-classical diction that the production can read as English-in-Lausanne
- ☐ Comic timing without anticipating the laugh
- ☐ Vocal flexibility across the five roles without losing the spine
- ☐ Earned theatricality in the shop-scene playing — the gallantry must sound rehearsed, not improvised

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Plays five roles as the same man underneath — the audience reads one character, five hats
- ☐ Vanity is defence; affection is real
- ☐ Does not know he is funny
- ☐ Self-correction at *I am through with this scene* reads as economic, not punchline
- ☐ Available to play the Leading Man playing the Father in the shop scene without losing his own ego under the role

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Physical specificity across the costume changes
- ☐ Comfortable with comic exposure — being laughed at without becoming sour
- ☐ Available for the shop-scene playing on the upper platform

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Takes notes about smaller — can dial vanity down without losing comedy
- ☐ Available to read each of the five hats in audition (one or two short beats apiece)
- ☐ Generous in scene with Player 2 in the shop-scene replay

NOTES

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☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

Player 2

the diva and the props (about 35)

About thirty-five — the real working professional Player 1 only impersonates; younger than him, and better at the job. The role asks for two registers in one body — the Leading Lady's wounded vanity and the Property Man's practical irritation — without losing the same woman in both.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Range from the diva's wounded indignation to the Property Man's quick functional dispatch
- ☐ Earned vanity in the voice (not defensive vanity)
- ☐ Comic timing that lands and then steps aside
- ☐ Available for a Step-Daughter line read inside the shop-scene replay without parodying

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Two registers, one woman — audience reads the same person across both
- ☐ Vanity is earned, not Player 1's defensive vanity
- ☐ The wound when the Step-Daughter laughs at her attempt lands as real, not as schtick
- ☐ *I have been made a fool of* — *believe me* — *by considerably better* — said meaning it
- ☐ Practical, no-nonsense Property Man bearing

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Comfortable flipping between Leading Lady and Property Man within a single scene
- ☐ Physical authority — reads as the most grounded professional in the room, not the eldest
- ☐ Available for the shop-scene playing on the upper platform
- ☐ Comfortable with stage objects (hats, screen, table, pegs)

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Takes adjustment on the wound — can play the Step-Daughter's laugh at her as private hurt or public offence
- ☐ Available to read across both registers in audition
- ☐ Generous in scene with Player 1

NOTES

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☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

Player 3

the youngest in the company

Early 20s, the youngest and happiest in the company — a young man or a young woman, the part fits either. Cannot believe they are paid to be in a theatre, and does a bit of everything (prompts, small parts, strikes the set, fetches props). Carries the Juvenile Lead and the Prompter, and is the audience's mirror across the second half — few lines after Act One, but a face that stays alive while watching the horror. Cast for curiosity, not naivety.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Earnest, open Juvenile Lead voice
- ☐ Quiet, meticulous Prompter voice (slightly older, in the box)
- ☐ A young voice, slightly rising at the end of clauses — undecided, but wants you to consider it

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Reads younger than the rest of the company from the back row
- ☐ Earnest, genuinely curious in the Juvenile Lead beats — curious, not naive
- ☐ Stays present as a witness through Act Two and Three without commenting on it

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Leans in when the Six speak; catches herself and colours
- ☐ Comfortable with the prompter's box for extended periods
- ☐ The face does the work in the second half — alive while watching

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Takes the single redirection and shifts cleanly
- ☐ Can play earnestness without tipping into cuteness
- ☐ Available to read both the Juvenile Lead and Prompter beats in audition

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Auditioner

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Madame Pace

the businesswoman of shame — her own performer

A Character carried by her own performer, no longer doubled by a Player. The production's most theatrically demanding role, and it lives entirely in one Act Two scene: she arrives comic and exits chilling. The role lives or dies on whether the dialect can hold meaning, and on whether the actor can be cold inside the comedy.

VOICE & BREATH

- ☐ Thick Italian-Swiss/French accent (in English) that carries meaning, not just sound
- ☐ Warm, smiling, practical — the cold is in the content, never the volume
- ☐ The arc inside one scene — vocal warmth on entry, cold by exit, smile never dropped

CHARACTER & TEXT

- ☐ Audience must laugh on the first line, regret laughing by the last
- ☐ The bookkeeping aria — *he clean, he polite, he pay cash* — lands as a transactional list, not theatrical menace
- ☐ Threat at the exit (*Don't you forget the name*) carried by stillness, not raised voice

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Inhabits the wig, the heels, the powder fully and without protective irony
- ☐ A hostess at her own front door — pleased, unhurried, never loud
- ☐ Available for the staged hand-under-chin moment with the Step-Daughter (brief, dressmaker-to-customer framing)

DIRECTION-TAKING & RANGE

- ☐ Available for adjustment on dialect — clearer or thicker
- ☐ Takes notes about the chill — can sharpen the cold register without losing the comedy
- ☐ Can hold the smile steady while the meaning underneath it turns

NOTES

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☐ Yes

☐ Maybe

☐ No

Auditioner

Date

Overall impression

After the role-specific pages — the actor's fundamentals across voice, body, text, ensemble, and direction-taking.

VOICE & SPEECH

- ☐ Audible projection to the back of the room
- ☐ Clear diction
- ☐ Vocal range and colour
- ☐ Breath control on long lines
- ☐ Tempo & pitch variation (not one-note)
- ☐ Earned pauses, not filler
- ☐ English diction comfortable
- ☐ French diction / accent comfort (for Players' Lausanne texture)

BODY & PRESENCE

- ☐ Centred posture; comfortable on stage
- ☐ Listens with the body
- ☐ Comfortable with stillness
- ☐ Specific gesture (not generalised)
- ☐ Spatial awareness of scene partners
- ☐ Comfortable with the chair-and-coat / bundle conventions
- ☐ Available for all scheduled rehearsal dates

TEXT WORK

- ☐ Comprehends what they're saying
- ☐ Discovers the word as they say it (not pre-loaded)
- ☐ Makes images, not just sounds
- ☐ Specific operative words
- ☐ Available for verse / broken-beat rhythms

ACTING FUNDAMENTALS

- ☐ Listens to scene partner; reacts in real time
- ☐ Specific choices, not generalised emotion
- ☐ Believes the words as they speak them
- ☐ Range — can shift register within a scene
- ☐ Risk-taking / vulnerability available
- ☐ Comedy timing without commenting on the joke
- ☐ Emotional honesty
- ☐ Stakes are felt, not announced

DIRECTION-TAKING

- ☐ Open to adjustment; willing to try the line again
- ☐ Holds an adjustment to the second take
- ☐ Range of changes available
- ☐ Asks specific questions, not vague ones
- ☐ Resilient under correction; does not become defensive

ENSEMBLE & PRACTICAL

- ☐ Generous in scene; does not pull focus
- ☐ Easy to work with in the room
- ☐ Punctual / prepared
- ☐ Headshot / résumé received
- ☐ Available for full rehearsal arc
- ☐ Available for callbacks

BIGGER QUESTIONS FOR THIS PRODUCTION

- ☐ Can hold the Characters' register (timeless, serious, ghost-like)
- ☐ Can hold the Players' register (local, modern, amateur in the best sense)
- ☐ Brings something we did not know we needed

DIRECTOR'S FINAL IMPRESSION

OVERALL

☐ Yes — cast

☐ Maybe — call back

☐ No

☐ Open for another role